

Spoken Tutorial on API Basics

Module	An introduction to Building
Episode	3. API Basics
Learning Objective	At the end of this tutorial learner will be able to 1. Define what an API is. 2. Explain the role of an API key. 3. Identify components of an API request.
Approx. Duration	3-4 min
Outline	• API Analogy: Restaurant Waiter • API Key • API Request
Meta Tags	API, API Key, API Request, AI, Spoken Tutorial, Programming, Development, Basics, Introduction, Messenger, Authentication, Building
Pre-requisite Tutorial	Module 2:Art of the Prompt

Script

Visual Cue	Narration
Title Slide	Welcome to this Spoken Tutorial on API Basics.
Learning Objectives Slide	In this tutorial, you will learn to, • Define what an API is. • Explain the role of an API Key. • Identify components of an API Request.
System Requirements Slide	Here I am using a browser on a computer or mobile.
Pre-requisite Slide	To follow this tutorial, you should have completed Module 2. This module is titled 'Art of the Prompt'.
Illustration of a waiter serving a customer at a restaurant, symbolizing an API connecting an application to an AI model.	Have you ever wondered how your application talks to a complex AI model? Think of an API as a helpful messenger. Imagine you are at a restaurant. The waiter takes your order to the kitchen. Then, the waiter brings your food back to you. In the same way, an API takes your request to the AI model. It then brings the model's response back to your application.

Illustration of a person showing an ID card to a bouncer at a restaurant entrance, symbolizing an API key for authentication.	But how does the AI model know it's you making the request? This is where an API Key comes in. An API Key is like your secret ID card or password. It tells the system that you are an authorized user. Just as an ID card allows you to order at a restaurant. Your API Key ensures only you can send requests to the AI model. It keeps your interactions safe and secure.
Illustration of a customer handing a menu with an order to a waiter, symbolizing an API request with an API key and prompt.	Now that you have your API Key, how do you actually talk to the AI model? You do this by sending an API Request. Think of it as placing your order with the waiter. Your API Request includes two main things. First, your API Key for authentication. This proves who you are. Second, your instruction or prompt for the AI model. The API then delivers your order to the model.
Summary Slide	Let us summarize what we learned. We defined an API as a messenger service. It connects your application with an AI model. We then discussed the API Key. This acts as your unique identifier for access. Finally, we explored an API Request. It is how you send instructions to the model. All these concepts were explained using a restaurant analogy.
Assignment Slide	Now as an assignment, Think of another everyday analogy for the API. Describe how it connects your application and an AI model. Compare this new analogy to the restaurant example.
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